

# DUDLEY JONES

Interview - August 1937

*96 Years Old*

RA-4RD 18 | 7-15-37

## THINGS TO ASK ABOUT AMONG PEOPLE LIVING WITHIN REACH OF THE RESETTLEMENT ADMINISTRATION PROJECT CALLED ROANOKE FARMS.

**Editorial note:** This is a clean typed-text edition made from the scanned historical interview. Original wording and period terminology are preserved. Where the scan itself is unclear, the transcription is conservative.

When you go to see somebody that you think will know something about old times ask him or her as many of these questions as you can and write down the answers.

**1. What was your father's name?**

"Wiley Jones."

**2. Who were his parents?**

"Don't know."

**3. What was your Mother's name?**

"Media Ann Jones."

**4. Who were her parents?**

"Don't know."

**5. Where was your father born?**

"Don't know."

**6. Where was he raised?**

"Halifax County."

**7. On whose place was he raised?**

"Pontan." (Pomery Plantation)

**8. What kind of work did he do?**

"Farm."

**9. Is he living? "No." If he is living, what is his age?**

If he is dead, when did he die, and at what age?

**10. Where was your mother born?**

"Don't know."

**11. Where was she raised?**

"Halifax County, N. C."

**12. On whose place was she raised?**

"Don't know."

**13. What kind of work did she do?**

"Farm."

**14. Is she living? "No." If she is living, what is her age?**

"Been dead years."

**15. Who used to own the land you live on now?**

"Ponton (Pomery) (This is one of the 8 negroes who bought 2000 acres which was Norfleet Farm.) He was already living here when the others bought with him."

**a. In slavery times?**

"Don't know."

**b. Shortly after freedom?**

"Don't know."

**c. How big was the place in slavery times?**

"Don't know."

**d. How many colored people did the owner have?**

"Don't know."

**e. Who owns it now?**

"I do."

**f. What crops did he raise?**

"Cotton, corn, peas."

**g. What have you heard about the way they grew these crops?**

"Same as always."

**16. What are the names of all your brothers and sisters?**

"Elijah Jones--dead. One half-brother, Henry Price, One half-sister, Mary Price."

**17. Where do they all live?**

"Don't know, here in Halifax." (Uncle Dudley very old and feeble, very deaf and losing his faculties too.)

**18. What brothers and sisters did your father have and where did they live?**

"Don't know. I was hired out to Bill Faucett during war."

**19. What brothers and sisters did your mother have and where did they live?**

"Don't know."

**20. What church are you a member of?**

"Daniel's Chapel."

**21. When was that church started?**

"No colored churches. Colored people set in church in gallery at night."

**22. How many preachers that have been regular preachers at that church can you give the names of?**

"Joseph Silver, Garland H. White, Jim Norton, Joseph Bazemore, 2nd., Jim Arrington, Nick Arrington."

**23. Can you say how many years each one was preaching at that church?**

"Joe Silver a long time."

**24. How many people do you know that are still living in your neighborhood that used to be slaves?**

"I'm the only one around here."

**25. Whose places were they on?**

*[No answer visible on the scanned page.]*

**26. Where do they live now?**

*[No answer visible on the scanned page.]*

**27. Have you heard anybody say who were good masters and who were bad masters?**

"Don't know. My master was good to me."

**28. What did the good ones do?**

"My master treated me all right."

**29. What did the bad ones do?**

"Don't know."

**30. When was the first colored school you ever heard of in that neighborhood started?**

"Mary Jones taught the first colored school at Daniel's Chapel. Just the folks around the land."

**31. Who taught it?**

"Mary Jones."

**32. How many children went to it?**

"Don't know--just those around this land."

**33. When did the first public colored school get built?**

"Didn't have a building until public schools came--used chapel."

**34. Where was it?**

"Daniel's Chapel."

**35. Who do you think among all the colored people in your neighborhood has done the most for colored people around there?**

"I helped all of 'em build their houses."